

Nordic Alert

30 April 2026

Oil prices pass previous high

Global key stories

Oil prices continue to rise and are trading above USD 125 per barrel this morning, thus surpassing the previous peak level from March 31. However, the June contract expires today and rolls over to July, which has also risen in price but "only" to \$114 per barrel. The deadlock between the US and Iran, where information to Axios claims that Trump is considering new military measures, characterizes the markets this morning. Interest rates are rising and the dollar has strengthened, while precious metals are rising after a few days of decline. The US stock markets developed a bit mixed yesterday with scattered outcomes for the reporting Tech giants, but the index closed to or just below zero. Japan's Nikkei is currently at -1.4%, and the Kospi at -1.3%. Stock market futures also indicate a negative opening in both Europe and the US. The market today also focuses on how the Bank of England and the ECB describe the outlook and risks related to the situation in the Middle East. The higher oil price contributes to NOKSEK now trading above parity again.

The Swedish fixed income market closes at 12.00 noon today, and the stock market at 13.00.

New Fed chair on the way, with a more divided view of the future. The Senate Banking Committee yesterday approved Kevin Warsh and sent him on for a vote in the Senate. His future colleagues decided at roughly the same time to keep the policy rate unchanged, but after three members reserved themselves against guiding on future interest rate relief, the Fed seems more divided than in a long time, see more [here](#).

A jam-packed statistical calendar. For those of us who cover the euro area, the day starts early and ends with the ECB just in time for the Swedish May bonfires are lit, and for the US we also find interesting statistics.

European inflation closely followed by the ECB. Inflation looks set to be slightly lower than market expectations in April, but it is still too early for the upside risks we see as a result of the Iran war to have materialised. Hence, indicators and the development of the conflict itself are of greater importance. And that is precisely why we believe that the ECB will keep the deposit rate unchanged today, but clearly indicate that it is prepared to raise the interest rate if necessary, read more [here](#).

Nordic key stories

Weak and shaky growth, surprisingly strong retail sales but depressed households is a good summary of the large bunch of growth statistics and the NIER Survey from yesterday, read more [here](#) and [here](#). On the Sweden theme, there are now also 30+ pages packed with various price charts for next week's CPI numbers [here](#).

Cheaper to refuel. Fuel prices have once again found their way up and petrol (not diesel) has reached a new peak level, although SEK 19.50/litre is clearly lower than what we had in June 2022. Tomorrow, however, the energy tax will be temporarily reduced and the petrol price will be SEK 1 lower (incl. the VAT effect), which means that the excise taxes have been reduced by SEK 2.85 since June 2022. Add to that

another 0.70 SEK per litre from a stronger krona (calculated on Brent oil), and you have a strong contributing factor to Sweden having among the lowest petrol prices in the EU (see chart below).

Today's key events

For graphs and analysis of the week's most important data, click [here](#)

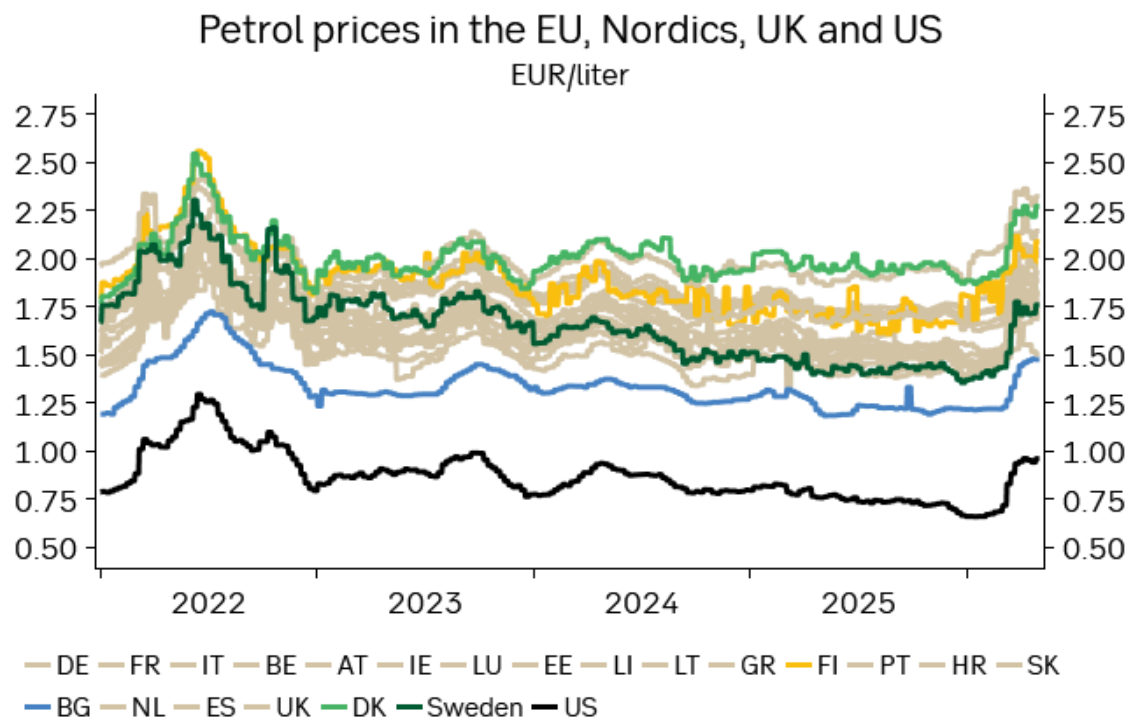
Time	Country	Event	Period	Consensus	Last
07:30	FRA	Consumer spending	Mar	0.7/---	0.933333333
07:30	FRA	GDP qoq yoy	Q1 P	0.2 1.2	0.2 1.2
08:00	NOR	Registered unemployment sa	Apr	--- ---	2.2 2.1
08:00	GER	Retail sales mom nsa yoy	Mar	-1	-1
08:45	FRA	CPI EU harmonized	Apr P	1.0/2.0 1.1/2.3	1.0/1.7 1.1/2.0
08:45	FRA	PPI	Mar	---/---	0.083333333
09:55	GER	Unemployment claims rate sa	Apr	3.5k 6.3	0.0k 6.3
10:00	NOR	Norges Bank's daily FX purchases net	May	--- ---	OK -50mn -174mr
10:00	IT	GDP wda qoq	Q1 P	0.1	0.3
10:00	GER	GDP sa qoq nsa yoy wda yoy	Q1 P	0.2 0.3 0.2	0.3 0.6 0.4
11:00	EA	GDP sa qoq sa yoy	Q1 A	0.2 0.9	0.2 1.2
11:00	EA	CPI core estimate yoy	Apr P	1.0/3.0 2.2 3.0	1.3/2.6 2.3 2.6
11:00	EA	Unemployment rate	Mar	6.2	6.2
11:00	IT	CPI EU harmonised	Apr P	1.5/2.5	1.7/1.6
13:00	UK	Bank of England bank rate	47574	3.75	3.75
14:15	EA	ECB deposit facility rate main refinancing rate	47574	2.00 2.15	2.00 2.15
14:30	US	Personal income spending real spending	Mar	0.4 0.9 ---	-0.1 0.5 0.1
14:30	US	PCE price index yoy core PCE price index	Mar	0.7/3.5 0.3/3.2	0.4/2.8 0.4/3.0
14:30	US	GDP annualised qoq personal consumption price index	Q1 A	2.0 1.6 ---	0.5 1.9 3.7
14:30	CAN	GDP	Feb	0.2/1.0	0.1/0.6
14:30	US	Initial jobless claims continuing claims (Apr 18)	45748	--- ---	214k 182k

Auctions: US to sell bills (17:30). **Speeches:** ECB's Lagarde holds press conference (14:45).

Market data

Equities	Index	Future	FX	Commodities
S&P 500	0.0%	-0.3%	EUR/USD 1.17	Brent fut \$/bl 125.4
Nasdaq comp	0.0%	-0.2%	EUR/SEK 10.88	Gold fut \$/oz 4550
Eurostoxx 50	-0.3%	-1.0%	USD/SEK 9.33	Government bonds yields
OMX Stockholm 30	-0.5%		EUR/NOK 10.87	US 10 year 4.43%
OBX Oslo	0.3%		USD/NOK 9.33	US 2 year 3.94%
OMX Copenhagen 25	-1.2%		NOK/SEK 1.00	Germany 10 year 3.11%
OMX Helsinki 25	0.9%		USD/DKK 6.41	Germany 2 year 2.74%
Nikkei225	-1.6%		USD/JPY 161	Sweden 10 year 2.90%
Shanghai Comp	0.1%		USD/CNY 6.84	Sweden 2 year 2.43%

US and Europe indices are change at yesterday's close

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